centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

HENOCH-SCHÖNLEIN PURPURA (HSP)

Your child has been diagnosed with Henoch-Schönlein Purpura (HSP), also known as IgA vasculitis. HSP is an inflammation of the small blood vessels. The exact cause is unknown. In many children, it appears to occur after a recent infection, when the immune system reacts in an unusual way. **HSP is NOT contagious**, and the *vast majority of children recover completely*.

WHAT SYMPTOMS CAN HSP CAUSE?

- **SKIN:** Small red or purple spots or patches, usually on the legs and buttocks. The rash may come and go over several weeks**.**
- **JOINTS:** Pain or swelling of the knees, ankles, or other joints. Some children may limp or temporarily refuse to walk.
- **STOMACH:** Crampy abdominal pain, nausea or vomiting. Less commonly, blood may be present in the stool.
- **KIDNEYS:** Kidney inflammation usually causes no symptoms at first. The only sign may be blood or protein in the urine.
- **LESS COMMONLY:** Boys may develop pain or swelling of a testicle. Rarely, other organs may be affected.

IS HSP A SERIOUS ILLNESS?

- **NO**. Most children recover completely within a few weeks.
- However, kidney involvement can develop even after the rash and joint pain have resolved. For this reason, follow-up is important for 6 months.

HOW IS HSP TREATED?

There is no treatment that immediately cures HSP. Treatment focuses on relieving symptoms and keeping your child comfortable.

- Rest as needed and drink plenty of fluids.
- Pain medication, such as acetaminophen or ibuprofen, if recommended by your healthcare professional.
- In some cases, corticosteroids may be prescribed for severe abdominal pain or certain complications.

WHEN SHOULD I SEEK MEDICAL CARE PROMPTLY?

- Severe or worsening abdominal pain
- Repeated vomiting
- Blood in the stool or urine
- Significant pain or swelling of a testicle
- Swelling of the face, hands, or feet
- Passing very little urine
- Unusual drowsiness / sleepiness or any symptom that concerns you

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WHAT SHOULD I MONITOR AT HOME?

Kidney involvement is often silent. Your child may appear completely well even if kidney inflammation is developing. A simple urine test can detect kidney involvement early and ensure appropriate follow-up or treatment if needed.

HOW SHOULD I MONITOR THE URINE?

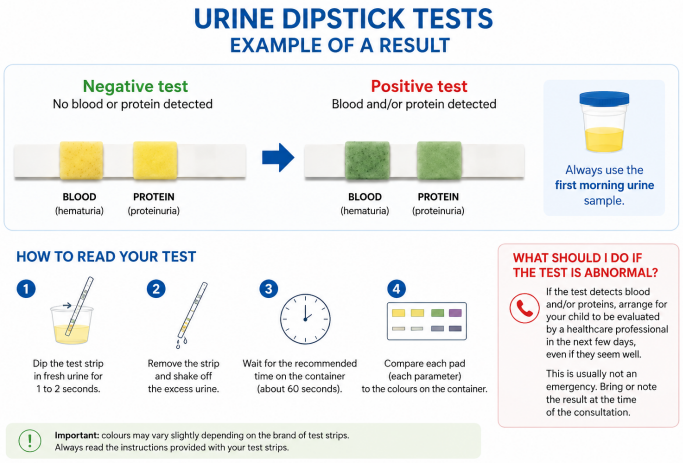
Check the **first morning urine** using the prescribed urine dipsticks:

- ✅ **Every Monday morning for the first 6 weeks**
- ✅ **Then on the first Monday morning of every month until 6 months after diagnosis**

WHAT SHOULD I DO IF THE URINE TEST IS ABNORMAL?

If the urine dipstick detects **blood or protein**, arrange for your child to be assessed by a healthcare professional **within the next few days**, even if your child seems well.

An emergency department visit is usually **NOT** necessary unless your child is also experiencing one of the warning signs listed above.



THE GOOD NEWS!

The vast majority of children recover completely from HSP. Urine monitoring is a precaution that helps identify the rare children who develop kidney involvement, allowing treatment to begin early if needed.

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